

Estimating Differences and Checking Answers

estimating a difference by rounding to the nearest ten or the nearest hundred, and using the estimate to decide whether an exact answer is reasonable

Directions

- To estimate a difference, round *both* numbers first, then subtract the rounded numbers.
 - Rounding to the nearest ten: look at the ones digit. Rounding to the nearest hundred: look at the tens digit. Below five rounds down; five or more rounds up.
 - An estimate is a check, not the answer. If an exact answer lands far from the estimate, something has gone wrong.
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1. A shop had 78 apples at the start of the day and sold 43 of them. About how many apples are left? Round each number to the nearest ten, then subtract.

Answer: _____ apples

2. A bus has 92 seats. At the first stop, 57 people got on and sat down. About how many seats are still free? Round each number to the nearest ten, then subtract.

Answer: _____ seats

3. A library owns 486 books and has 218 of them out on loan. About how many books are on the shelves? Round each number to the nearest hundred, then subtract.

Answer: _____ books

4. A farm collected 634 eggs and packed 297 of them into boxes. Mia says 437 eggs are left.

(a) Estimate the number left by rounding each number to the nearest hundred. _____

(b) Find the exact number of eggs left. _____

(c) Is Mia's answer reasonable? Explain, using your estimate.

5. A stadium has 852 seats. For one match, 419 seats were sold. About how many seats were unsold? Round each number to the nearest hundred, then subtract.

Answer: _____ seats

6. A school printed 725 flyers and handed out 348 of them.

(a) Estimate the number of flyers left by rounding each number to the nearest hundred.

(b) Now find the exact number of flyers left. _____

7. A jar held 64 marbles and 28 were taken out. About how many marbles are left? Round each number to the nearest ten, then subtract.

Answer: _____ marbles

8. A warehouse held 803 boxes and 465 were shipped out. Ben worked out how many were left and wrote 438.

(a) Estimate the number left by rounding each number to the nearest hundred. _____

(b) Explain how your estimate shows that 438 cannot be right.

(c) Find the exact number of boxes left. _____

9. A cinema sold 906 tickets over a weekend. Of those, 448 were sold on Saturday. About how many tickets were sold on Sunday? Round each number to the nearest hundred, then subtract.

Answer: _____ tickets

10. Two students estimated $512 - 288$ in different ways. One rounded to the nearest ten; the other rounded to the nearest hundred.

- (a) Round to the nearest ten and subtract. _____
- (b) Round to the nearest hundred and subtract. _____
- (c) Find the exact difference. _____
- (d) Which estimate landed closer to the exact difference? Explain why.
